

Theme: Health and Nutrition

Title of the Story: Sheela Devi's Awareness and Understanding Saved Soniya's Life

- Location: Motihari, East Champaran

- Project: CRY-AM

- Child's Name: Soniya Kumari

- Age: 1 year 4 months

- Gender: Female

- Father's Name: Dharmendra Sahni

- Mother's Name: Sheela Devi

- Community: OBC

- Village: Sehni tola , Bardaha, Motihari, East Champaran, Bihar

- Access to Hospital:

The district hospital is 25 km away. A primary health center is located 7 km from the village, but it lacks enough health workers. For better treatment, families often need to travel to the district hospital in Motihari or to private clinics.

- About the Family:

There are three sons and two daughters in the family, and Soniya is the youngest of them all. The family depends on daily wage labour for their livelihood.



- Head of the Family and Occupation:

The head of the family does farming and labour work. They are poor and belong to a BPL (Below Poverty Line) family. Their financial condition is not good.

With the help of CRY-AM and CHARDS, our organization works in 25 hamlets across 5 panchayats.

- About CHARDS: - Comprehensive Health and Rural Development Society (CHARDS) is a non-profit, non-political, secular and social organization, registered under Societies Registration Act 21, 1860. It was founded in 2004. It has been working on health and nutrition in 3 panchayats of Motihari for the last several years under the support and guidance of CRY – AM.

- Problem:

In our area, there is a village called Sahni Tola. A girl named Soniya Kumari belongs to the OBC community. She was suffering from severe malnutrition. Soniya's parents were very worried about her health. They are daily wage labourers and support their family through this work.

Due to lack of proper food and care, Soniya became seriously ill. When she was 1 year and 4 months old, her weight was only 4 kg. She was severely malnourished. She was very weak, cried all the time, and did not behave like other normal children.

Her parents did not have enough money to take her to a doctor for proper treatment.

Project Intervention (Role of CRY-AM and CHARDS):

During a household visit and monthly community meeting organized by CRY and CHARDS, Soniya was identified as a malnourished child while monitoring growth at the Anganwadi center. Her parents were encouraged to take her to the Nutrition Rehabilitation Centre (NRC), but they initially refused out of fear and mistrust.

Then, Nima Rani, a field worker from CHARDS, spoke with the Anganwadi worker, the ASHA, and elderly villagers to explain the importance of NRC services. Soniya's parents were made aware of the benefits of sending her to the NRC. After talking with another mother who had returned from the NRC with her healthy child, Soniya's mother agreed.

On 4th March 2025, with the help of CRY and CHARDS members, Soniya was admitted to the NRC. Her condition was monitored regularly by phone, and after 10 days of treatment at the NRC, she returned home. Project staff followed up with home visits and stayed in contact with the family.

- Positive Change in Parents through Project Intervention:

Earlier, Soniya's parents did not trust government healthcare and refused to send her to the NRC. But after Soniya's recovery through NRC support, they thanked CRY and CHARDS members, saying, "You all saved our child's life." Now they trust government healthcare services and are more aware. They take better care of Soniya and understand the importance of health and nutrition.

- Current Condition of the Child:

Soniya is now active like other children her age. Her malnutrition is under control, and her weight is increasing. She is now healthy and fit.

- Overall impact of the project: - Now they have faith in the scheme run by the government and they got government benefits. Sheela Devi is very happy to see her child healthy today and says that due to awareness, Soniya is healthy today and plays and eats like normal children. She says that all this has been possible due to the awareness, cooperation and regular participation in meetings done by CHARDS workers and today my child is healthy. All the workers of CHARDS wish for his good health. . They tell the people around them about the work of CHARDS and CRY-AM and are spreading awareness in the community.

Thank you

Annexure 2. INFORMED CONSENT FORM TEMPLATE

Title of the Intervention: CHARDS

Objective/Purpose: To make the community aware that they must get their childrens vaccine and save their children from malnutrition

About the Programme: Health and nutrition

Procedure:

Please mention the exact procedure for enrolling children in step by step simple manner

Please mention if any filming/photography is going to be done.

Consent of the child:

I Soniya Kumari confirm that I am willing and voluntarily agreeing to participate in the described programme above that is being organized by CHARDS, Motihari (organization). I have been explained the purpose of the programme.

I also give my consent that the organization may use some or all parts of the media products/contribution coming out of the event/photography/filming by the organization and its partners worldwide without restriction.

I also give my consent that the organization may use some or all parts of the responses coming out of the programme by the organization and its partners worldwide without restriction. I have been informed by the organization that this will be used for social development purpose only to ensure and promote child rights.

I have also been informed that a due consent has also been taken from my parents/guardians.

I have been told that during the programme, I will have the right to withdraw at any point in time.

Name: Soniya Kumari

Age: 1 year 6 month

Location/address (will not be shared with anyone):

Signature:

Date: 20/05/2025

**Consent of the parents/guardian**

I/we have understood the purpose of the programme and agree to the following:

That the children and I/we have no objection to let my child voluntarily participate in this programme.

That the responses given would be used and shared with different stakeholders and audiences on various print or any other media platforms and that I/we have no objection to it.

That the photographs or video are recorded and shared with different stakeholders and audiences on various print or any other media platforms and that I/we have no objection to it.

I have been informed by organization that this will be used for social development purpose only to ensure and promote Child Rights.

Name and Signature of the parent/s:

દામેકુસહની

Date: 20/05/2025

For Project Partner:

I certify that I have explained about the programme to દામેકુસહની (Name of parent) and believe that they understand the process and have agreed to allow their child to participate freely. I agree to answer any additional questions when they arise afterward.

Name of the નીમારાની સિક્કાર (designation) & Contact no: 62018 07658

Date: 20/05/2025 નીમારાની સિક્કાર



Consent by third party:

In case of the child, parent, guardian unable to read or write, an independent person should sign on behalf of them. This could be a teacher or community volunteer. The third party person should explain to the family the above mentioned detail of the programme.

I undersigned have helped the parents to understand the Informed consent form and its content.

Name

Date

Signature

Consent taken by

Name and Signature

Date